

SafetySense

George Teifel · Mary Teifel

UNM & CNM APP CONTEST 2026

WHO WE ARE

SafetySense calls for help when you can't.

George Teifel

University of New Mexico

Senior · Electrical Engineering

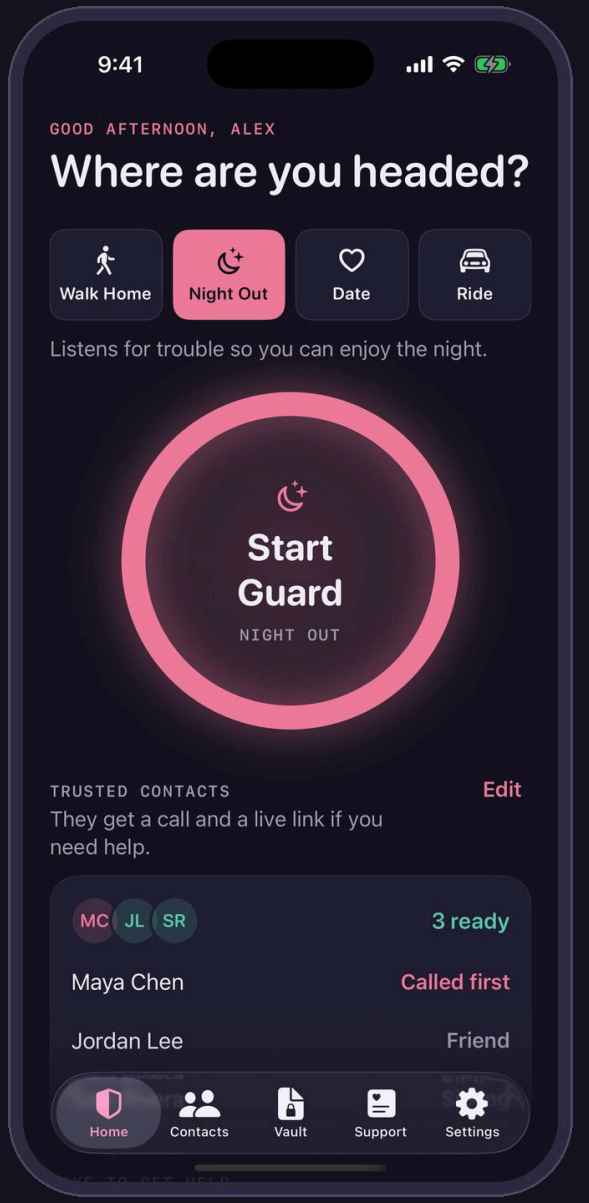
Built the iOS app and the backend

Mary Teifel

Central New Mexico Community College

Dual credit student · Mechanical Engineering

Research, design and the app's wording



THE PROBLEM

Most safety apps wait for you to press a button or set a timer

70%

of 298 women reported significant tonic immobility, an involuntary freeze, during sexual assault

Möller et al., Acta Obstet Gynecol Scand, 2017 (n = 298)

Freezing is involuntary

It is a normal response, not a choice.

Phones get taken, broken or switched off

A dead phone sends nothing.

Speaking isn't always possible

Even texting 911 takes a phone in your hand.

What if you can't press the button?

“Most safety apps”: based on the documentation of the apps we reviewed. We did not test them.

OUR ANSWER

You turn on a Guard. If you can't respond, it acts for you.

START IT

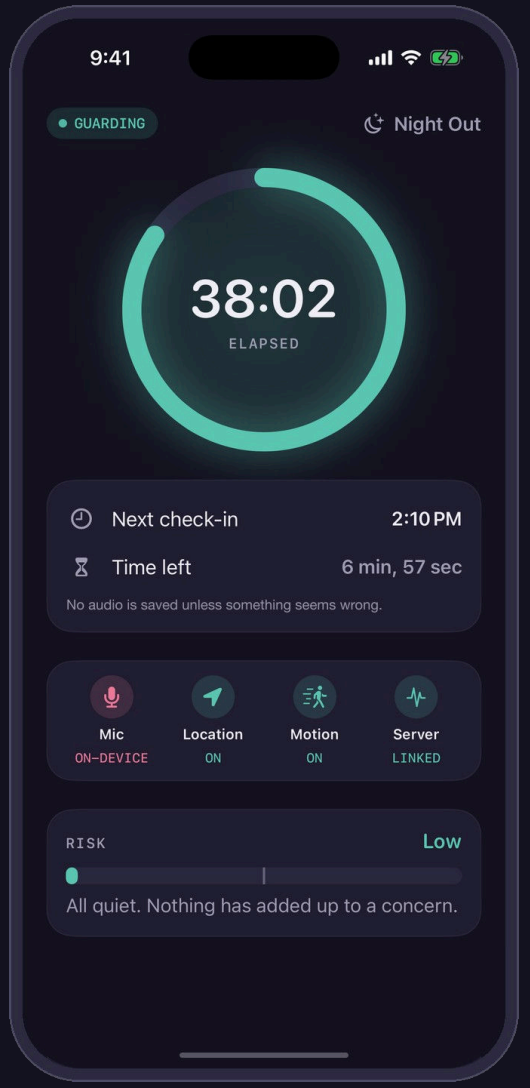
Before a walk home, a night out, a date or a ride, tap Start Guard.

Or skip straight to an alert with the Action Button or Siri.

WHAT IT WATCHES FOR

- **Screams**
- **Breaking glass**
- **Safe word**
- **Fall, then stillness**

It only listens while a Guard is on.



BUILT WITH

A native iPhone app · The listening happens on the phone
Real phone calls · Professional dispatch (test system today)

Watch three things.

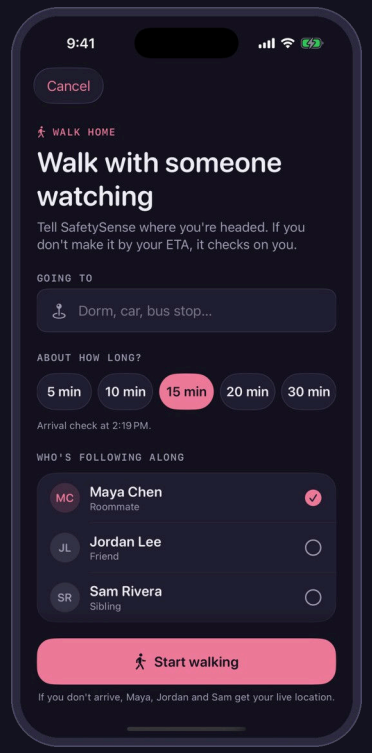
1. It asks before it alerts.
2. What her friend sees, and who's called if no one answers.
3. What happens if someone makes her cancel, or breaks her phone.





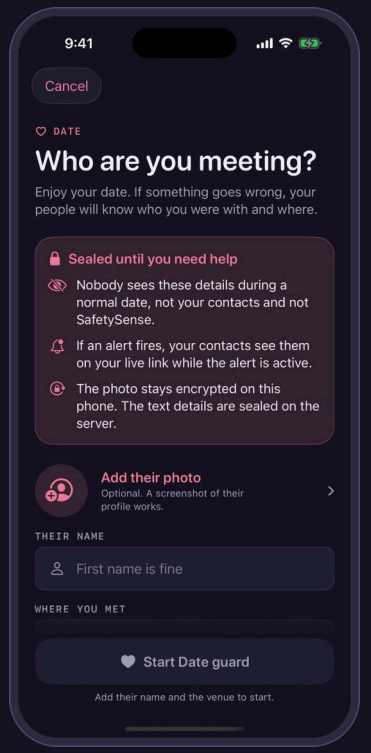
MORE THAN ONE NIGHT

Built for the nights students actually have



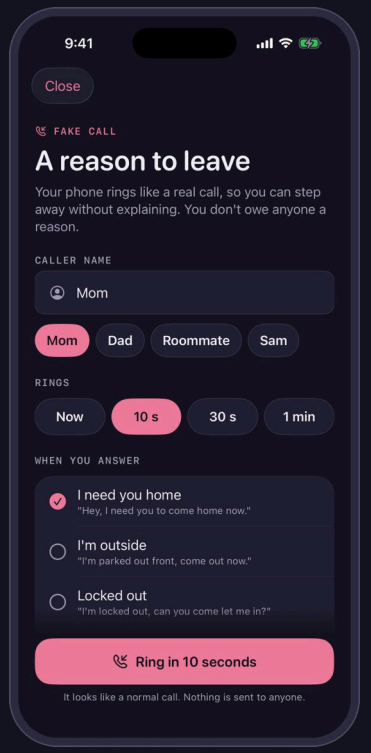
Walking home

If you don't arrive on time, it checks on you.



A first date

Who you're meeting stays sealed unless you need help.



A way out

A fake call gives you a reason to leave.

ORIGINALITY

Others have pieces. We connected the chain.

	UNM Safe	Noonlight	bSafe	Apple built-in	SafetySense
Notices distress on its own	–	Crash (paid)	Voice phrase	Crash; fall on Watch	✓ **Sound, motion, context**
Acts when the phone goes dark	–	Not documented	Not listed	Check In, timing varies	✓ **Our server notices**
Duress PIN (fake cancel)	–	–	Not listed	–	✓ **The two PINs you saw**
Professional dispatch	Call UNMPD	✓	–	911 call	✓ **Yes (test system)**
Live location to a friend	✓	✓	✓	✓ Check In	✓

From each product's documentation; not tested by us. These are four tools a student could already have.
Their columns are shipped products. Ours is a prototype; dispatch runs in a test system.

DESIGN AND EXPERIENCE

Designed for the worst night of someone's life

Calm words, never blame

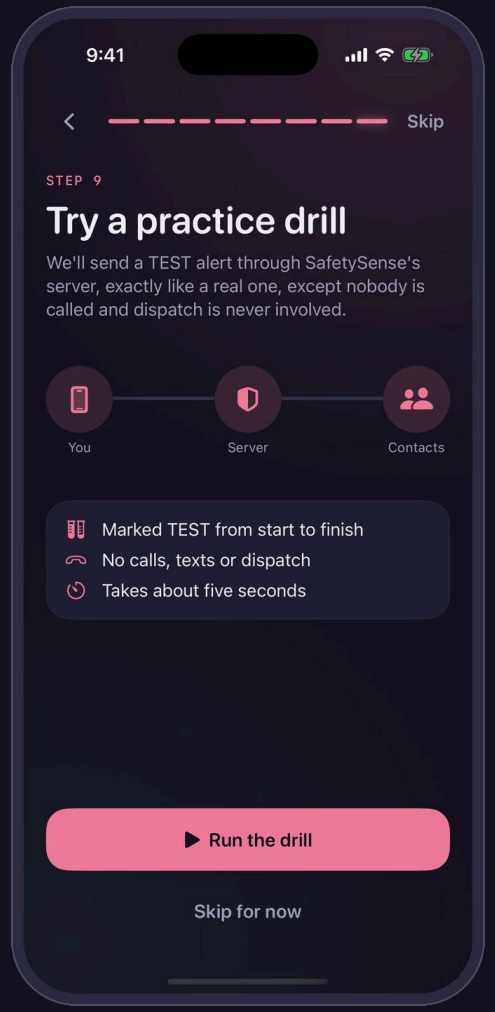
Written to be calm and never blaming.

Your first alert is a drill

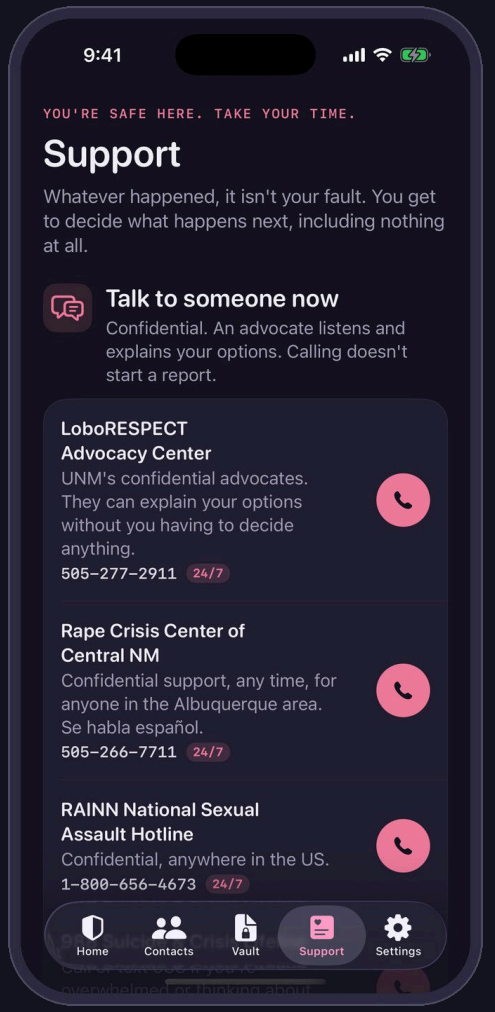
Onboarding ends with a practice run marked TEST.

Afterward, you choose

An advocate, medical care, reporting, or keeping it private.



The practice drill



Support, afterward

PRIVACY AND SECURITY

Private by default. Evidence only when it matters.

1

Guard on

Listening happens on the phone

2

Only the last 30 seconds

Kept in memory, then overwritten

3

Only if an alert fires

Audio is locked on the phone before upload

4

Vault

Opens with your Face ID. You decide who hears it

No audio is saved unless an alert fires

No ads, no trackers

Live links are built to expire after the alert

WHAT'S NEXT

From a working app to students' phones

1

Students test it

UNM and CNM students use it and tell us what to fix.

2

Advocates review it

People who work with survivors check every word.

3

Campus partnership

Work with the safety and advocacy offices on campus.

HOW IT PAYS FOR ITSELF

Free for students.

The school pays for a campus licence, the way schools already pay for safety apps.

A paid plan for people who aren't students.

Today: a working app in a private test build. Not tested with real users yet, and no agreements signed.

SAFETYSENSE

When you can't call for help, SafetySense does.

SafetySense supplements 911. It never replaces it.

George Teifel UNM **Mary Teifel** CNM

Thank you. We'd love your questions.

